

Tales of the Telegraph

lighting my lamps, sat down and wrote
rs and read, when I was not taking train
rs. This office was kept up solely because it
a convenient place to deliver orders to freight
as at night when they stopped for water.

about twelve-thirty in the morning my door
ed suddenly, and a man stepped quickly in.
as startled because this was almost the only
except the pumper and the train crews that
been there since I came. Once in a while a
y tramp had gone through, but this man was
a tramp. He wore a long overcoat, buttoned
is chin, with the collar turned up. A slouch
pulled well down over his eyes so far concealed
ace that his features were scarcely visible. He
e over to my desk and gruffly asked, "What
is there a passenger train east to-night?"

answered that one went through at half past
the Overland Flyer, but it did not stop at
eda. Quick as a flash he pulled a revolver
poking it in my face, said, "Young man, you
your red-light and stop that train or I'll make
cancy in this office mighty d——d quick."

he longer I gazed down the barrel of that re-
er the bigger it grew, and it looked to me as if
was loaded with buck-shot to the muzzle.
en it had grown to about the size of a gatling

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gun (and it didn't take long to do it), I concluded
that "discretion was the better part of valor," and
reached up and turned my red-light. Meanwhile
the door opened again, and three more men came
in. They were masked and the minute I saw
them I knew they were going to make an attempt
to hold up the Overland Flyer. Often this train
carried large amounts of bullion and currency
east, and I supposed they had heard that there was
a shipment to go through that night.

I was standing with my back to the table, and
just then I heard the despatcher say that the Flyer
was thirty minutes late from the west. I put my
hands quietly behind me and let the right rest on
the key. I then carefully opened the key and had
just begun to speak to the despatcher when one of
the men suspected me and said to the leader, "Bill,
watch that little cuss. He's monkeying with the
instrument and may give them warning."

I stopped, closed the key, and was trying to
look unconcerned, when "Bill," said that "to stop
all chances of further trouble," they would bind
and gag me. Thereupon two of the men tied my
hands in front of me, bound my legs securely, and
thrust a villainously dirty gag in my mouth.
When this was done, "Bill" said, "Throw him
across those blamed instruments so they will